EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY

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SUSTAINABILITY REPORT





16 PEACE, JUSTICE AND STRONG INSTITUTIONS

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 16 PEACE, JUSTICE AND STRONG INSTITUTIONS

16.2.1 Elected Representation



16 PEACE, JUSTICE AND STRONG INSTITUTIONS

16.2 University Governance Measures

16.2.1 Elected Representation

At Eastern Samar State University (ESSU), highest-level governance is rooted in participatory leadership, multi-sectoral dialogue, and inclusive representation. According to the organizational framework of the **ESSU Board of Regents (BOR)**—the institution's highest governing body—key internal university sectors sit directly alongside national, regional, and sector leaders to shape high-level policies, strategic priorities, and institutional directions.

The Board structure ensures direct, democratic representation across all primary internal academic stakeholders:

- **Student Representation:** Students are actively represented by the **Student Regent** (sitting as the President of the Federated Student Council Organization, Inc.), ensuring student perspectives, rights, and welfare are directly brought to the highest policy-making table.
- **Faculty Representation:** Academic and teaching personnel are represented by the **Faculty Regent** (sitting as the President of the Federated Faculty Association), providing a direct conduit for faculty concerns, academic quality, and staff welfare in university governance.
- **University Administration & Staff Leadership:** Administrative continuity, operational management, and institutional stewardship are represented by the **University President**, who serves as the **Vice Chairperson of the Board of Regents**.
- **Alumni Representation:** Former students maintain a permanent voice in shaping the university's future through the **Alumni Regent** (sitting as the President of the Federated Alumni Association), anchoring institutional growth to regional impact and alumni engagement.

Completing this diverse governing body are key public and civic representatives, including the Commissioner of the Commission on Higher Education (CHED) as Board Chairperson, leaders from the Senate and House Committees on Education, Regional Directors from NEDA and DOST, and private sector representatives. By incorporating elected representatives from the student body, faculty, alumni, and administrative executive leadership into its highest governing board, ESSU reinforces its dedication to participatory governance, institutional transparency, and shared accountability across the university community.

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 16 PEACE, JUSTICE AND STRONG INSTITUTIONS

16. 2.2 Student Union

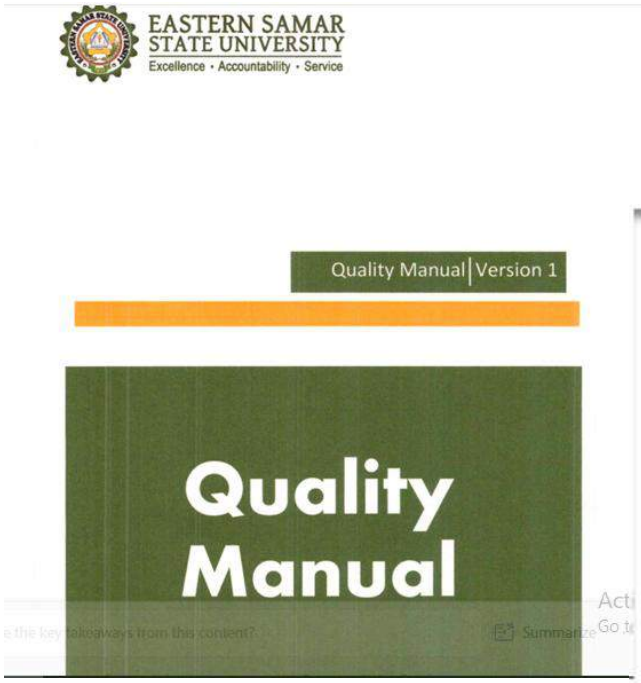


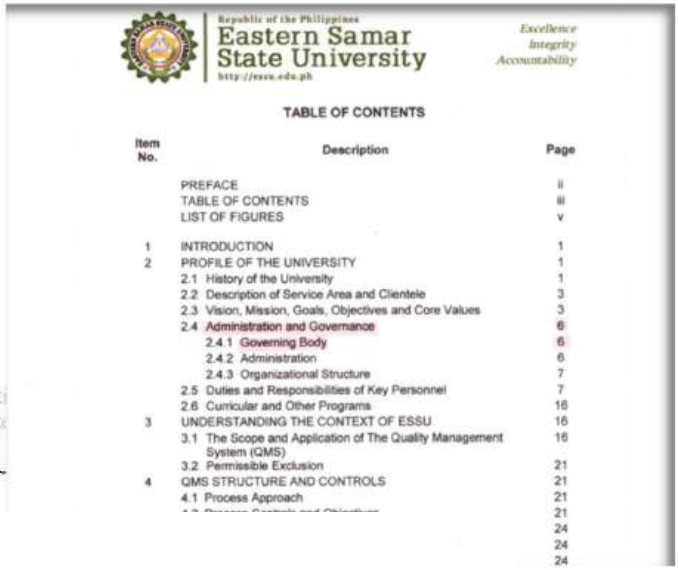
16 PEACE, JUSTICE AND STRONG INSTITUTIONS



Supporting Documents

ESSU Quality Manual where Composition of the Governing Body is enumerated





Republic of the Philippines
Eastern Samar State University
http://essu.edu.ph

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Integrity
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2.4 Administration and Governance

Governing Body of ESSU

The governing body of ESSU is the Board of Regents which is composed of the following:

(a) The Chairperson of the Commission on Higher Education (CHED), as chairperson;
(b) The President of the University, as vice chairperson;
(c) The Chairperson of the Committee on Education, Arts and Culture of the Senate, as member;
(d) The Chairperson of the Committee on Higher and Technical Education of the House of Representatives, as member;
(e) The Regional Director of the National Economic and Development Authority (NEDA), as a member;
(f) The Regional Director of the Department of Science and Technology (DOST), as a member;
(g) The President of the federation of faculty associations of the University, as a member;
(h) The President of the federation of student councils of the University, as a member;
(i) The President of the federation of alumni associations of the University, as a member, and
(j) Two (2) prominent citizens from the private sector who have distinguished themselves in their profession or fields of specialization of the University, as members.

Administration

The administration of the University is vested in the President who is appointed by the Board of Regents, upon the recommendation of a duly constituted search committee.

https://drive.google.com/file/d/11H2zhRkijxPWMObMqOP66rhwHIRDfKcx/view?usp=drive_link

16. 2.2 Student Union

At Eastern Samar State University (ESSU), student empowerment, democratic representation, and participatory decision-making are institutionalized through the existence of its official Students' Union: the **Federated Student Council Organization, Incorporated (ESSU-FSCO, Inc.)**. Recognized as the highest policy-making body representing the entire studentry across all ESSU campuses, the Students' Union operates under a ratified Constitution and By-Laws dedicated to advancing student rights, fostering leadership, and safeguarding student welfare.

Central to its organizational setup, the Students' Union ensures that student perspectives directly influence high-level university governance:

- **Elected Autonomous Representation:** The Students' Union comprises elected leaders from the Supreme Student Councils (SSCs) across all five ESSU campuses—Main (Borongan), Maydolong, Salcedo, Guiuan, and Can-avid. Officers and representatives are chosen through democratic, multi-campus elections administered by an independent Student Electoral Commission (SEC).

- **Direct Voice in Institutional Governance:** By virtue of Republic Act 9312 and the FSCO Constitution, the elected **President of the ESSU-FSCO, Inc.** automatically serves as the official **Student Regent** on the **Board of Regents (BOR)**—the highest governing body of the university.

- **Equal Voting Power & Policy-Making:** Sitting as a regular, voting member of the BOR alongside university executives, national lawmakers, and government directors, the Student Regent brings the collective voice, concerns, and recommendations of the student body directly to university leadership. This position guarantees that students possess a direct vote in approving academic calendars, university budgets, student handbooks, and institutional policies.

By embedding the Students' Union leadership into the Board of Regents, ESSU upholds the principles of transparent administration, accountable leadership, and genuine student participation at every level of university decision-making.



SOCIAL SUPPORT FOR STUDENTS

In steadfast alignment with its mandate under Article II of its Constitution and By-Laws to promote the overall welfare, mental, social, and physical development of all Eastern Samar State University students, the **Federated Student Council Organization, Incorporated (ESSU-FSCO, Inc.)** maintains a dedicated commitment to spearheading impactful social support activities across all campuses. The Students' Union systematically organizes student-centered initiatives, peer assistance programs, financial aid awareness drives, and inclusive community engagement projects designed to foster a nurturing academic environment. Recognizing the importance of holistic student life, the FSCO actively hosts and supports social events—such as annual Acquaintance Nights, sports fests, cultural nights, and university wide socio-cultural gatherings—creating inclusive spaces where students can freely socialize, build meaningful friendships, and relieve academic stress. By converting student trust fees directly into these vital support networks, social gatherings, and advocacy campaigns, the FSCO ensures that every scholar receives the comprehensive social, emotional, and material backing required to thrive throughout their academic journey at ESSU.

OFFICE OF THE BOARD OF REGENTS

EXCERPT FROM THE MINUTES OF THE 1ST QUARTER BOARD MEETING OF THE ESSU BOARD OF REGENTS HELD ON APRIL 1, 2025 AT HIGHER EDUCATION DEVELOPMENT CENTER (HEDC) BUILDING, DILIMAN QUEZON CITY.

RESOLUTION No. 65, Series of 2025

A RESOLUTION RECOGNIZING HON. REYNA ERIKA T. RIVERA, PRESIDENT OF THE FEDERATED STUDENT COUNCIL ORGANIZATION (FSCO), INC. AS A REGULAR MEMBER OF THE ESSU BOARD OF REGENTS, EFFECTIVE IMMEDIATELY.

Certified Correct:

DEBBIE JOYCE R. VOLOSO, DM
Board Secretary V

ESSU BOARD SECRETARY OFFICE
RELEASED INITIAL
DATE: 10/10/25

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BAGONG PILIPINAS

EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY
FEDERATED STUDENT COUNCIL ORGANIZATION, INCORPORATED
STUDENT ELECTORAL COMMISSION
RESOLUTION NO. 2 SERIES OF 2025

RESOLUTION ENDORSING HON. REYNA ERIKA T. RIVERA, THE NEW FEDERATED STUDENT COUNCIL ORGANIZATION, INCORPORATED (FSCO, Inc.) PRESIDENT, AS STUDENT REGENT OF EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY BY VIRTUE OF RA 9312, AN ACT CONVERTING THE EASTERN SAMAR STATE COLLEGES (ESSC) INTO A STATE UNIVERSITY TO BE KNOWN AS THE EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY.

Held at the Eastern Samar State University, FSCO, Inc. Election 2024: on February 7, 2025, 9:00–4:00 PM, at ESSU Can-avid Campus via on-site election, the following resolution was approved, and the same has not been altered, revoked, or modified.

WHEREAS, the Federated Student Council Organization, Incorporated (FSCO, Inc.) Election 2025 was conducted on February 7, 2025, at the Gymnasium, Eastern Samar State University Can-avid Campus, Can-avid Eastern Samar.

WHEREAS, the Student Electoral Commission (SEC) identified twelve (12) voting rights for each local Supreme Student Council (SSC). As such, there were a total of sixty qualified voters for all five (5) ESSU campuses: Main, Maydolong, Salcedo, Guiuan, and Can-avid.

WHEREAS, among the official candidates for all the elective positions, the following set of newly elected officers were proclaimed by the SEC, to wit:

Position	Names	Total Number of Votes
President	RIVERA, REYNA ERIKA T.	48
Internal Vice President	ACOSTA, GENE DANIEL C.	56
External Vice President	BAQUILOD, KYLA MAE T.	51
Secretary General	URSAL, JOHN MARL Z.	44
Treasurer	BAGOYORO, JAMES DARR B.	45
Auditor	GADE, ALMERA S.	43
PRO	ALDAY, NOEL JR. A.	47

WHEREAS, provided in the Constitution and By-laws of Eastern Samar State University Federated Student Council Organization, Incorporated (ESSU-FSCO,Inc.) Article 8, Section 1, and concurrently supported with the Implementing Rules and Regulations on the Conduct of Election for the Federated Supreme Student Council Organization, Incorporated Article 1, Section 1, the FSCO, Inc. The president will no longer be elected but instead will follow this sequence below and hold office for one (1) school year or until a new president has been chosen.

Maydolong (S.Y.: 2016-2017)
Salcedo (S.Y.: 2017-2018)
Can-avid (S.Y.: 2018-2019)
Guiuan (S.Y.: 2019-2020)
Main (S.Y.: 2020-2021)

WHEREAS, the outgoing student regent comes from the ESSU Salcedo Campus; hence, the next student regent will be from the ESSU Can-avid Campus.

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WHEREAS, as mandated by R.A. 9312, An Act Converting The Eastern Samar State Colleges (ESSC) Into a State University to be Known as the Eastern Samar State University, Section 5(h), the Governing Board of the University shall be the Board of Regents, which includes the President of the Federated Student Council of the University that will sit as the Student Regent.

WHEREAS, the SEC hereby endorses the newly elected FSCO, Inc. President, Hon. Reyna Erika T. Rivera of ESSU Can-avid Campus as the new student regent to the ESSU Honorable Board of Regents, through the University and Board Secretary, Dr. Debbie Joyce R. Voloso, to adopt the same.

NOW THEREFORE, RESOLVED, AS IT HEREBY RESOLVED, to endorse Hon. Reyna Erika T. Rivera, President of the Federated Student Council Organization, Incorporated (FSCO, Inc.), as Student Regent of Eastern Samar State University by virtue of RA 9312.

Prepared by:

JAKE P. RAYLA
Chairperson - Guiuan Campus

SHILOH ISHA DURAN
Vice Chairperson - Guiuan Campus

ARCHIE R. ACHAS
Secretary - Can-avid Campus

PATTY MAE B. JUSAY
SEC Member - Can-avid Campus

EMMANUEL L. LOMIARES
SEC Member - Can-avid Campus

JUNILO E. ABLAY
SEC Member - Main Campus

WILTER DONCERAS ORQUITA
SEC Member - Main Campus

JESIMAE BABES R. DALINA
SEC Member - Main Campus

ANGEL GRACE C. GARADO
SEC Member - Salcedo Campus

REUEL B. FAJARDO
SEC Member - Salcedo Campus

JAMIR L. LACDAO
SEC Member - Salcedo Campus

ARAH MAE M. MALIPOT
SEC Member - Guiuan Campus Campus

KAYE ELEAN BOBIER GUNDA
SEC Member - Maydolong

ALJON ANDAY
SEC Member - Maydolong Campus Campus

RONALD CAPONES
SEC Member – Maydolong

EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY
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EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY
STUDENT ELECTORAL COMMISSION

CERTIFICATE OF CANVASS OF VOTES AND PROCLAMATION OF WINNING CANDIDATES FOR PRESIDENT, VP INTERNAL, VP EXTERNAL, SECRETARY, TREASURER, AUDITOR AND PUBLIC RELATIONS OFFICER OF THE FEDERATED STUDENT COUNCIL ORGANIZATION, INCORPORATED

FEDERATED STUDENT COUNCIL ORGANIZATION, INC. ELECTION
FEBRUARY 7, 2025

WE, THE UNDERSIGNED constituting the **FSCOI BOARD OF CANVASSERS** of Eastern Samar State University do hereby certify, under our officials' oaths:

1. That we have duly canvassed the election returns in the precinct(s) comprising the aforesaid FSCOI in the Election held on February 7, 2025, and that the attached hereto and forming part hereof is/are Statement of Votes by Precinct (SOVP) with serial number_____ of the votes cast therein for each candidate; and

2. That the following candidates obtained the highest number of votes indicated opposite their names:

NAME OF CANDIDATES	**NUMBER OF VOTES RECEIVED**	
	(In Words)	(In Figures)
President:		
RIVERA, REYNA ERIKA T.	Forty - Eight	48
VP Internal:		
ACOSTA, GENE DANIEL	Fifty - Six	56
VP External:		
BAQUILOD, KYLA MAE T.	Fifty - One	51
Secretary:		
URSAL, JOHN MARL Z.	Forty - Four	44
Treasurer:		
BAGOYORO, JAMES DARR B.	Forty - Five	45
Auditor:		
GADE, ALMERA S.	Forty - Three	43
Public Relations Officer:		
ALDAY, NOEL JR. A.	Forty - Seven	47

IN VIEW OF THE ABOVE RESULTS, we herby **PROCLAIM** the above-mentioned candidates as the duly elected Officers, Federated Student Council Organization, Incorporated.

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BAGONG PILIPINAS

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, we have hereunto affixed our signatures this 7th day of February, 2025 at Eastern Samar State University – Can-avid Campus.

JAKE P. RAYLA
Chairperson - Guiuan Campus

SHILOH ISHA DURAN
Vice Chairperson - Guiuan Campus

ARCHIE R. ACHAS
Secretary - Can-avid Campus

PATTY MAE B. JUSAY
SEC Member - Can-avid Campus

EMMANUEL L. LOMIARES
SEC Member - Can-avid Campus

JUNILO E. ABLAY
SEC Member - Main Campus

WILTER DONCERAS ORQUITA
SEC Member - Main Campus

JESIMAE BABES R. DALINA
SEC Member - Main Campus

ANGEL GRACE C. GARADO
SEC Member - Salcedo Campus

REUEL B. FAJARDO
SEC Member - Salcedo Campus

JAMIR L. LACDAO
SEC Member - Salcedo Campus

ARAH MAE M. MALIPOT
SEC Member - Guiuan Campus Campus

KAYE ELEAN BOBIER GUNDA
SEC Member - Maydolong

ALJON ANDAY
SEC Member - Maydolong Campus Campus

RONALD CAPONES
SEC Member – Maydolong

Constitution and By-Laws of Eastern Samar State University Federated Student Council Organization, Incorporated (ESSU-FSCO,INC

CONSTITUTION AND BY-LAWS OF EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY FEDERATED STUDENT COUNCIL ORGANIZATION, INCORPOPRATED (ESSU-FSCO, INC.)

PREAMBLE

We, the students of Eastern Samar State University with the help of Almighty God, believing in the need for better organized student council and the development of the youth as leader of the nation, do hereby promulgate and adopt this Constitution and By-Laws of Federated Student Council Organization, Inc. that shall advance, implement and maintain our goals and aspiration, embody the ideas of principle of freedom, equality, justice and democracy and promote the welfare of all students and the academic standards of our University.

Article I
NAME AND DOMICILE

Section 1: **NAME.** The Organization shall be called Eastern Samar State University-Federated Student Council Organization, Incorporated (ESSU-FSCO, Inc.) of Eastern Samar State University.

Section 2: **SEAL.** The Organization shall adopt the ESSU Seal with the letters ESSU-FSCO, Inc. added under the seal.

ESSU-FSCO, Inc.

Section 3: **DOMICILE.** The ESSU-FSCO, Inc. office shall be located within the campus of the Eastern Samar State University, Borongan City, Eastern Samar, Philippines.

Article II
DECLARATION OF OBJECTIVES

Section 1: The objectives of the ESSU-FSCO, Inc. shall be as follows:

a. To train members for effective and responsible leadership.
b. To create and nurture the love for education, research and extension activities.
c. To promote and maintain the highest level of scientific, vocational and academic excellence among students.

C

d. To promote justice, respect the highest rights of the students, faculty and staff and administrative officials. It shall uphold the basic ideals and rights of the students and adhere to the democratic principles and aspirations of ESSU studentry.
e. To serve the University and studentry with the highest degree of efficiency and effectiveness.
f. To promote and develop each member mentally, socially, physically and culturally.
g. To establish an organization that will represent the students of all campuses in collective negotiations beneficial to the members.
h. To serve as the voice and ears of the students' concern.

Article III
MEMBERSHIP

Section 1: All students regardless of status, race, nationality, religion and political affiliation who are officially enrolled in all campuses of Eastern Samar State University are deemed bonafide members.

Article IV
FEES/FINANCES

Section 1: The ESSU-FSCO, Inc. funds shall be classified into Trust Funds and Special Funds. "Trust Funds" shall consist of the Federated Supreme Student Council (FSSC) membership fee of Ten Pesos (Php 10.00) paid upon enrollment every semester which shall be collected by the cashier of all campuses with the official receipt of ESSU and directly deposit in any organized bank (DBP, PNB, Metrobank, etc.) as Council's fund. "Special Funds" are funds that come from donations, sponsorship, fund-raising project or any amount derived from legitimate sources.

Section 2: All receipts of money from all sources shall be evidenced by an acknowledgement receipt.

Section 3: Withdrawal of the fund may be done by following the process prescribed by the University.

Section 4: The Organization shall likewise engage in any lawful activities that may help raise funds to defray the necessary expenses of the organization.

Section 5: The organization shall enjoy the freedom to determine its priorities in the disbursement of its fund, provided that it shall be actually, directly and exclusively used to support and/or finance the programs, projects, activities and Maintenance and Other Operating Expenses (MOOE) of the Organization and must provide an approved Activity/Training Design and Endorsement Resolution from the body.

Section 6: At the end of every activity, the involved ESSU-FSCO, Inc. officers shall liquidate and pre-audit the expenses in accordance with the proper accounting and auditing

procedures of the University before another disbursement or bank withdrawal shall be authorized.

Article V
RIGHTS, PRIVILEGES AND OBLIGATIONS

Section 1: Rights, Privileges and Obligations of Members

The students enrolled in all campuses shall have the following rights, privileges, and obligations provided under existing laws:

a. It is the right of every member to choose freely a field of study based on existing school curricula and the determination of tuition fees and other school obligations based on school rules and regulations.
b. It is the right of every member to participate, vote and be voted in all elections, plebiscites, referendum and any issue involving their welfare.
c. It is the right of every member to have access to his/her school records, which shall be maintained and preserved in a confidential manner by the University.
d. It is the right and privilege of every member to establish, join and participate in any student organization or association recognized by the University whose aims are not in contrary to its laws and policies.
e. It is the right of every member to be heard and be investigated fairly and judiciously for any action taken by the University against him/her
f. It is the right of the member in all campuses to publish an independent student newspaper or any similar publications and to invite resource person/s during assemblies, symposia, and other activities of the same nature.
g. It is the right of every member to be free from involuntary contributions except those approved by the body sponsoring committees and SSC of their respective campus.
h. It is the right of every member to be informed by the council of its plans, programs, projects, accomplishments, financial reports and all activities concerning their welfare.
i. It is the responsibility of every member to maintain the norms of scholarship and academic excellence.
j. It is the right of every member to receive competent, relevant quality instruction and to make sufficient use of the library and other facilities and to avail the services offered in the University with the corresponding obligation to protect the latter.
k. It is the right of every member to continue his/her study until he/she shall have graduated from his/her course, except in case of academic deficiency or violations of disciplinary rules and regulations.
l. It is the right of every member to receive their grades ten (10) working days after the final examination, provided that all the requirements of the students are accomplished.
m. It is the obligation of every member to participate in every duly approved activity organized by any recognized clubs and/or organizations of the University provided that the activity concerns the member.

Article VI
ORGANIZATION OF THE COUNCIL

Section 1: **NATURE:** The ESSU-FSCO, Inc. is an organization of the students of all campuses of Eastern Samar State University, who are adhering to this constitution, its principles and programs and to all policies promulgated by its members.

Section 2: **COMPOSITION:** The Federated Student Council Organization, Incorporated of Eastern Samar State University shall be composed of all Supreme Student Council Officers and its members.

Section 3: **POWERS AND FUNCTIONS:** The ESSU-FSCO, Inc. shall be the highest ~~policy making~~ body of the ESSU studentry and shall have the following powers and functions:

a. To legislate laws and regulations pertaining to the ESSU-FSCO, Inc.,
b. To work for the preservation of an independent student council that will assert and uphold the interest of the studentry and the people.
c. To implement and execute laws, policies, rules and regulations of the organizations which are not contrary to the laws of the University.
d. To serve as the active forum for the sentiments and interests of students in all ESSU Campuses.
e. To work for the promotion and upliftment of the spiritual, moral and social consciousness of the studentry.

Section 4: **MEETINGS:** The Executive Officers and Members of the ESSU-FSCO, Inc. shall have a regular meeting once in every two months during Fridays and/or Saturdays of the said month with appropriate notice to be sent by the secretary at least Ten (10) working days prior to such meetings. The Council shall determine the place and time of the meeting to be stated in the notice.

Section 4a: Communication letters sent less than ten (10) working days prior to the meeting shall be considered invalid unless specified as urgent/special meeting.

Section 4b: Urgent/Special Meetings maybe called by the President as maybe deemed necessary or maybe proposed through the President by one-third (1/3) members of the council. Notice shall be made by the Secretary General at least five (5) working days prior to the said meeting.

Section 5: **QUOROM AND RULES OF ORDER:**

Section 5a: Except when the position is required by law, a majority vote (50%+1) shall prevail at meetings and deliberations of the ESSU-FSCO, Inc.

Section 5b: All meetings shall follow the following order of business:

5b.a: Opening Ceremony

5b.a.a: Invocation

5b.a b: Singing of the National Anthem

5b.b: Business Meeting/Planning Session

5b.b.a: Roll call and determination of quorum
5b.b.b: Call to order by the presiding officer
5b.b.c: Reading and approval of the previous minutes
5b.b.d: Reports
5b.b.e: Unfinished Business (if any)
5b.b.f: New Business
5b.b.g: Itemized Discussion
5b.b.h: Other Matters
5b.b.i: Announcements (if any)

5b.c: Closing Prayer

5b.d: Adjournment

Section 5c: Officers must wear ESSU-FSCO, Inc. Uniform and I.D. in all meetings and activities.

Section 6: **COMMITTEES:** The organization shall have the following standing committees. Each committee shall compose of a chairman and five (5) members representing other external campuses (one member per campus) but not limited thereto.

a. Committee on Rules and Regulation
b. Committee on Election
c. Committee on Audit
d. Committee on Finance
e. Committee on Projects and Services
f. Committee on Membership
g. Committee on Grievance and Welfare
h. Committee on Constitutional Amendments

Section 7: **FUNCTIONS:** The following Committees shall have the following functions:

A. *The Committee on Rules and Regulations shall:*

a.1. Study and Review all rules, resolutions, memoranda, and other special matters before it will be passed for the approval.
a.2. Investigate complaints against any student in any cases of violation to this constitution and the promulgate rules and regulations of the college and its duly constituted authorities.
a.3. Submit such cases to the proper authority for immediate action.
a.4. Perform such other functions as maybe delegated by the council.

B. *The Committee on Election shall:*

b.1. Enforce and administer all laws and regulations relative to the conduct of the elections.

b.2. Appoint qualified election officials.

b.3. Require and receive certificated of candidacy and other documentary requirements from all candidates to elective positions in the federation.

b.4. Decide on all election cases and proclaim winners of the election.

b.5. Perform such other functions delegated to the committee as may be deemed necessary.

C. *The Committee on Audit shall:*

c.1. Examine the financial statement prepared by the Treasurer to determine the accuracy of the accounts as well as the figure appearing therein.

c.2. Check the flow of the funds in the council.

c.3. Reports to the council any cases pertaining to irregularities for appropriate actions.

c.4. Perform such other functions delegated to the committee by the federation.

D. *The Committee on Finance shall:*

d.1. Responsible for raising funds for the purpose of the federation.

d.2. Administer and control the inflow and outflow of funds of the federation.

d.3. Prepare the annual budget program of the federation.

d.4. Perform such other function delegated by the council.

E. *The Committee on Projects and Services shall:*

e.1. Study and monitor feasible projects that will contribute for the betterment of the university.

e.2. Support and coordinate community extension projects of the University.

e.3. Pass the findings of the project studied to the executive council of the organization for further approval.

e.4. Perform such other functions delegated by the federation.

F. *The Committee on Membership shall:*

f.1. Be responsible in gathering the necessary data related to all members of the federation.

f.2. Keep and safe guard the same for documentary purposes.

f.3. Study any cases pertaining to membership and submit the same to the Executive Council for action.

f.4. Perform such other functions as may be delegated by the federation.

G. *The Committee on Grievance and Welfare shall:*

g.1. Responsible for investigation and solution of disputes involving students to promote and protect the general welfare of the members.

g.2. Procedure of Amicable Settlement:

g.2.1. Any student who has grievance claim, he/she must submit a written complaint to their Local SSC President and in turn shall refer the said complaint to their Local Grievance Committee.

g.2.2. In the event of the failure of the Local Grievance Committee to settle the dispute amicably, this will be referred to the Committee on Grievance Committee and Welfare of ESSU-FSCO, Inc. and after which shall decide the merit of the case and shall proceed to the process of investigation.

H. *Committee on Constitutional Amendments*

h.1. Study the Constitution and By-Laws of ESSU-FSCO, Inc.

h.2. Propose possible amendments of the Constitution.

h.3. Pass the findings of the studied Constitution to the Executive Council for action.

h.4. Perform such other functions as may be delegated by the federation.

Article VII
OFFICERS
(COMPOSITION, TERM OF OFFICE, DUTIES AND RESPONSIBILITIES)

Section 1: **COMPOSITION.** The Executive Board of Federation shall be composed of the following officers: one (1) President, two (2) Vice-Presidents (External and Internal), one (1) Secretary General, one (1) Treasurer, one (1) Auditor, one (1) PRO and the Board of Representatives.

Section 1.1. The Board of Representatives shall be the President of each campus, provided he/she is not elected as member of the Executive Board. If the situation warrants, the officer next in rank shall serve as its Board of Representative.

Section 2: **TERM OF OFFICE.** Member of the Executive Board shall hold their office for one (1) school year or until a new set of officers had been elected.

Section 3: **QUALIFICATIONS.** Only SSC President of all campuses provided he/she possesses the right qualification shall be eligible to become the President of the Federation. Other SSC Executive Officers may run the rest of the offices.

a. Must have a good character and no administrative case against him/her in and outside of the University.
b. Must have a minimum of fifteen (15) units on his/her academic load.
c. Must have no failing grades on his/her academic subjects.
d. Must have general weighted average of 2.0 and above from the first year to the current election.
e. Must not be a graduating student prior on the election.

Section 4: **DUTIES AND FUNCTIONS:**

A. ***PRESIDENT.*** The president shall perform the following duties and responsibilities;

1. Shall be selected from the Campus reign of Presidency as stated in Article VIII Section 1 of this Constitution.

2. Shall act as the Chief executive of ESSU-FSCO, Inc.
3. Shall preside over all meetings and deliberation of the Executive Board and the General Membership.
4. Shall appoint all the members of the Standing Committees of the Federation with the concurrence of majority of the membership of the executive Board;
5. Shall approve orders covering the applications of expenditures of the federation's fund before payment of disbursement made by the Treasurer with the concurrence of the Auditor;
6. Shall have the power to create Special Committee/s as the need arises;
7. Shall call special meeting of the Federation of the Executive Board wherever deemed necessary or upon written request of at least 30% of the members of the council or a majority of the members of the executive Board;
8. Shall designate the Vice-President as officer In-charge in case he/she is absent or incapacitated;
9. Shall exercise to vote in case of tie;
10. Shall represent the federation in all occasions and in matters where the representation of the federation is required; and
11. Shall enforce the provision of the constitution and all other rules and regulations which maybe promulgated from time to time.

B. ***VICE-PRESIDENT:***

The External Vice-President shall:

1. Be designated as officer-in-charge and shall perform the functions and duties of the President in case of the latter's death, permanent incapacity, absence, impeachment and resignation;
2. Be an ex-officio member of all standing committees of the federation;
3. Assist and coordinate with the President regarding all the matters concerning the welfare of the federation; and
4. Perform such other function as may be designated by the President.

The Internal Vice-President shall:

1. Perform the functions and duties of the external Vice-President in case of the latter's death, permanent incapacity, absence impeachment and resignation;
2. The VP shall assist and coordinate with the President regarding all matters concerning the welfare of the federation;
3. Participate and vote in all council deliberation; and
4. Perform such other function as maybe designated by the President.

C. ***SECRETARY GENERAL:*** The Secretary General shall:

1. Head and administer secretaries of the federation;
2. Administer the day to day activities of the federation;
3. Undertake the special task assigned to him/her by the President;
4. Take charge of the safekeeping and updating of the records of the council;
5. Prepare sign or at least, record in books and file communications, resolution, documents and notice of meeting pertaining to the council upon consultation with the President/Council;

6. Take down the minutes of all the meeting of the council and shall certify the same; and
7. Act as Head of the Committee on Membership.

D. ***TREASURER:*** The Treasurer shall:
1. Collect, receive and issues receipts for all funds and contributions of the federation;
2. Make sure that all disbursement and payment made by him/her are supported by vouchers and official receipts;
3. Keep records of all expenditures and other financial records;
4. Keep a list of unpaid dues of each regular member;
5. Formulate pertinent financial guidelines for the organization; and
6. Act as head of the Committee on Finance.

E. ***AUDITOR:*** The Auditor shall:
1. Audit, verify and examine all financial accounts of the federation. He/she supervise the entries in the books of the accounts of the federation and shall render reports in his/her audit as may be required by the Executive Board or by resolution of at least 20% of the officers of the local Student Council;
2. Assist the Treasurer in formulating financial guidelines and reports; and
3. Act as head of the Committee on Audit.

F. ***PUBLIC RELATION OFFICER (PRO):*** The PRO shall:
1. Take charge of all the matters involving public relations of ESSU-FSCO, Inc.;
2. Establish linkages with other groups, agencies or institution that have similar aspiration with the ESSU-FSCO, Inc. with the approval of the Executive Council; and
3. Put up official publication or through any communication media to disseminate programs and activities of the ESSU-FSCO, Inc. as well as inform the studentry of its accomplishments and financial reports.

Article VIII
ELECTION AND TRANSITION

Section 1. **PRESIDENT.** The FSCO, Inc. President will no longer be elected, instead will follow this sequence below, and will hold office for one (1) school year or until a new President has been chosen.

- Maydolong (S.Y.: 2016-2017)
- Salcedo (S.Y.: 2017-2018)
- Can-Avid (S.Y.: 2018-2019)
- Guiuan (S.Y.: 2019-2020)
- Borongan (S.Y.: 2020-2021)

Section 1.1. This provision must be irrevocable until all the campuses will be given equal opportunity to serve the position.

Section 2. Vice Presidents (External and Internal), Secretary General, Treasurer, Auditor and PRO of the Federation shall be elected through a secret ballot by the officers of the Supreme Student Council.

Section 3. DATE. The FSCO, Inc. election shall be held yearly on the third Saturday of April.

Section 4. A majority votes shall elect an officer of the executive board. In case of a tie, the SEC will have the discretion on how to settle it and will not exceed for one (1) week from the date of declaration of the said.

Section 5. Any defeated candidate or his authorized representative may file an election protest to the SEC within one (1) week from the time the case is submitted for decision.

Section 6. All elected members of the Executive Board shall be inducted by the University President or his/her Representative or any public officer duly authorized to administer one (1) week after the proclamation of the winning candidates and shall assume office thereafter.

Section 7. The Implementing Rules and Regulations (IRR) on the conduct of FSCO, Inc. Elections will be made by the Student Electoral Commission (SEC) to further discuss the election matters and be open for amendments depending upon the need of the Council.

Article IX
FEDERATION ADVISER

Section 1. The Federation President shall recommend a Federation Adviser with the concurrence of the Executive Board who shall serve for one (1) year or until a new set of officers assume office. The said Federation Adviser shall be a full-time faculty with permanent status and must have at least one (1) year experience as adviser of any recognized student organization in the University.

Section 2. It shall be the duty of the Federation Adviser to supervise all deliberations and activities of the Federation. However, he/she shall not exercise any voting power during such deliberations but rather serves only as a consultant on any manner under considerations of the Federation.

Section 3. The Federation Adviser may be replaced at any time for any act or commission (negligence of duties, falsification, forgery, and other unlawful acts) prejudicial to the students and federation upon recommendation of the Federation President with concurrence of 2/3 vote of the Executive Council called for the purpose.

Article X

RECALL, SUSPENSION, RESIGNATION AND VACANCIES

Section 1. Any of the following shall be ground for recall of the federation officers:

a. Committing or causing the act directly or indirectly against the interest and welfare of the federation; | written endorsement coming from the chairman of the committee.
b. Malicious attacks against the Federation, its officers or against a fellow Federation officer or member;
c. Gross negligence of duty;
d. Willful and culpable violation of the Constitution and By-Laws;
e. Misappropriation of the Federation Funds and misuse of property. This without prejudice to filing of an action against responsible officer(s) by any interested party; and
f. Two unjustifiable absences from regular meeting. - 3 unjustifiable absences

Section 1.1 The following shall govern the recall proceeding:

a. Recall proceedings shall be initiated by a formal petition or resolutions signed by the majority (50%+1) of all bonafide officers of the Federation addressed to the highest officer not in petitioned for recall.
b. The Executive Council shall then convene a general membership meeting to consider the recall of an officer.
c. Federation officer against whom impeachment or recall charges have been filed shall be given opportunity to defend himself/herself before any recall vote is finally taken.
d. A two-thirds (2/3) vote of the Executive Council shall be required to recall Federation Officer.
e. A Federation Officer recalled shall be considered resigned, or ousted from office and shall no longer be elected nor appointed to any position in the Federation.
f. The decision of the Executive Council on the recall charge shall be final and executory by two-thirds (2/3) vote of the SSC Officers present during recall proceedings.

Section 2: **SUSPENSION**: As an alternative to recall, ESSU-FSCO, Inc. officers may be suspended when found guilty of any of the delinquencies as stipulated in Article X, Section 1 as ground for disciplinary action.

Section 2.1: The ESSU-FSCO, Inc. officers to be suspended will/shall be informed through written notice of the proceedings not later than five (5) working days before a meeting call for that purpose.

Section 2.2: The Special Committee shall render suspension of the ESSU-FSCO, Inc. Officer to be suspended and shall be barred from attending one (1) regular meeting of the Federation.

Section 2.3: A two-third (2/3) votes of Special Committee Members present is needed to approve the suspension upon hearing their defense.

Section 2.4: The recommendation and decision of this Special Committee shall be final and irrevocable.

Section 2.5: Suspended ESSU-FSCO, Inc. officers shall not be allowed to participate in deliberations, voting and exercise their duties and powers as council member.

Section 3: **RESIGNATION**: Resignation upon elected or appointed officer shall be in written and shall take effect five (5) working days after the day of the approval of the majority of the ESSU-FSCO, Inc. officers. However, no member/officer may be approved for resignation from his/her tenure during any period in which he/she has pending obligation with the office.

Section 4. **VACANCIES:** Any vacancy in any of the positions for the reason of death, resignation, recall and any unexpected incidents shall be filled through Rule of Succession.

Section 4.1: Any vacancy in the Federation, except the position of the President, shall be filled within (10) working days from the day the position is rendered or considered vacant, by appointment of the ESSU-FSCO, Inc. officers among the qualified members.

Section 4.2: The SEC shall certify the vacancy occurring in the Federation and the ESSU-FSCO, Inc. Adviser shall certify the fact of appointment of the vacant position/s.

Article XI
AMENDMENTS/REVISIONS

Section 1. Any amendment/s or revision/s of any part of this Constitution may be proposed by the Executive Council upon the vote of two-thirds (2/3) of all SSC Officers of ESSU Campuses at special meeting called for the purpose.

Section 1.1. No proposals should be considered amended/revised and becomes part of this ESSU-FSCO, Inc. Constitution and By-laws without approval of at least two-third (2/3) votes of the council or a majority vote (50% + 1) of the general members present in a meeting or referendum called for the purpose.

Section 1.2. No proposals for amendments should be made within three (3) years after the ratification of this constitution.

Section 2: This Constitution and By-Laws may be dissolved only when the organization seized to exist.

Article XII
EFFECTIVITY

Section 1. The Constitution and By-Laws shall take effect immediately after its ratification by a majority of votes casted by the SSC Officers of all ESSU Campuses whose presence are called for the purpose.

AMENDED AND RATIFIED ON THIS 25th DAY OF FEBRUARY 2017 AT ESSU CAN-AVID CAMPUS BY A UNANIMOUS VOTE OF THE MEMBERS OF THE FEDERATED STUDENT COUNCIL ORGANIZATION, INCORPORATED OF EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY.

REGIE E. ATO
FSCO, Inc. President
ESSU Maydolong

REYMUND D. PINANDO
ESCO, Inc. External Vice President
ESSU Can-avid

JOHN JOSHUA L. CANCILLER
FSCO, Inc. Internal Vice President
ESSU Salcedo

BERT JAMESON D. DARIA
FSCO, Int. Secretary General
ESSU Guiuan

RAYMOND T. ARAGON
FSCO, Inc. Treasurer
ESSU Guiuan

ARJIE O. GONGON
FSCO, Inc. Public Relation Officer
ESSU Borongan

MARICHU A. EVARDONE
ESSU Can-avid

EINNA MIKEE C. MOSCOSA
ESSU Can-avid

MARK PATRICK P. BALACA
ESSU Can-avid

GLECERIO R. GEROY, JR.
ESSU Can-avid

JESS AIAN C. GEROY
ESSU Can-avid

ELLA V. MICHELENA
ESSU Borongan

ED BERT CHRISTIAN D. DARIA
ESSU Guiuan

JESSA B. LIZONDRA
ESSU Guiuan

JASON D. MACALONA
ESSU Guiuan

CHRISTOPHER IVAN I. SALAMIDA
ESSU Guiuan

GLENN A. SACLOLO
ESSU Guiuan

RYAN CHRISTIAN A. IDA
ESSU Guiuan

MARICHU D. PADRIQUEZ
ESSU Guiuan

ALBERT B. YAPE
ESSU Borongan

ALEXANDRA C. RONCAL
ESSU Borongan

JOHN KEITH S. AZUL
ESSU Borongan

MARK JHON O. BERONGOY
ESSU Salcedo

ROMEO E. ROSAL, JR.
ESSU Maydolong

JAYSON G. ANOL
ESSU Salcedo

MAIKA NIDA ALIDON
ESSU Maydolong

ADRIAN A. ASPA
ESSU Borongan

ELLIANRY B. CAVITE
ESSU Maydolong

MARY ANN D. TOMENIO
ESSU Maydolong

JOANA E. AMARRA
ESSU Borongan

Documentation of oathtaking of Hon. Reyna Erika T. Rivera

ESSU - Federated Student Council Organization Inc.
February 18, 2025 ·

The newly elected officers of the Federated Student Council Organization Inc. of Eastern Samar State University were officially sworn in during the highly anticipated 4th State of the University address, delivered by Dr. Andres C. Pagatpatan, Jr., on February 17, 2024, at the Eastern Samar State University - Can-avid campus.

This important occasion ushers in their tenure as they assume their new leadership positions, prepared to serve and represent the entire student body of Eastern Samar State University with zeal and determination. See less



Supreme Student Council - ESSU Can-avid
February 18, 2025 ·

Congratulations to Hon. Reyna Erika T. Rivera and Hon. John Marl Z. Ursal our newly elected President and Secretary-General of the Federated Student Council Organization Incorporated! You made us beam with pride, and we are always grateful for your unwavering dedication to serve the student body.

Congratulations on your well-deserved victory! Your leadership, perseverance, and compassion have truly paid off. We're excited to see the positive impact you'll have to our fellow students. We're confident that your passion and vision will guide us towards a brighter future.

#AllForlovelierESSU See less



Student-Led Activities





Acquaintance Party (Link to Facebook Post)





Sports Activities (Link to Facebook Post)





Cultural Events ASEAN Map Challenge (Link to Facebook Post)



Educational Webinars (Link to Facebook Post)

Link to Facebook Posts of the Student Union

- ESSU - Federated Student Council Organization Inc.
- College of Technology and Architecture
- College of Nursing and Allied Sciences
- College of Education
- College of Agriculture

- College of Engineering
- College of Science
- College of Law
- College of Business Management and Accountancy
- College of Hospitality Management
- College of Arts and Social Sciences
- College of Computer Studies

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 16 PEACE, JUSTICE AND STRONG INSTITUTIONS

16. 2.4 Participatory Bodies for Stakeholders



16 PEACE, JUSTICE AND STRONG INSTITUTIONS

At Eastern Samar State University (ESSU), local stakeholders—including local residents, local government units (LGUs), civil society representatives, business operators, and community organizations—are empowered to actively participate in university decision-making through formal, multi-layered institutional mechanisms. Direct engagement in top-level governance is guaranteed by the university's highest governing authority, the **ESSU Board of Regents (BOR)**. The BOR integrates representative voices from across the academic and civic community, including the **Student Regent** (President of the Federated Student Council Organization), the **Faculty Regent** (President of the Federated Faculty Association), the **Alumni Regent** (President of the Federated Alumni Association), and **two Private Sector Representatives**. Furthermore, national lawmakers and public policy representatives sit on the Board via the Chairpersons of the Senate Committee on Education, Arts and Culture and the House Committee on Higher and Technical Education, ensuring that legislative and public sector perspectives shape institutional policies.





Link to Facebook post

Whenever top management decisions directly impact the university's internal and external community, stakeholder participation is systematically facilitated and ensured. ESSU guarantees that stakeholders are continuously invited, consulted, and provided accessible platforms to air sentiments, voice concerns, and collaboratively develop administrative solutions.

Demonstrating this commitment to inclusive decision-making and open dialogue, ESSU actively engages local stakeholders through targeted consultative mechanisms and forums:

- **University-Wide Stakeholders' Consultation on Major Operations:** To discuss key administrative changes—such as the adoption of the "Sal-ong" graduation regalia, proposed tuition fee adjustments, new school uniform guidelines, and vehicle gate pass policies—ESSU convened a comprehensive consultative forum at Canuctan Hall. The session brought together Federated Class Organization (FCO) officers, student leaders across all campuses, alumni, parents, faculty, deans, and the **ESSU Tricycle Operators and Drivers Association (TODA)**. Stakeholders engaged in transparent discussions, raised operational concerns, and actively participated in voting on proposed fee structures, ensuring administrative decisions reflect community consensus.





Link to Facebook post

- **Local Service Providers and LGU Collaboration:** ESSU Maydolong hosted a dedicated Stakeholders' Dialogue with local boarding house operators and canteen owners in partnership with the Municipal Government of Maydolong. Attended by LGU officials (including the Chief of the Business Permits and Licensing Office and Municipal Councilors), the dialogue established shared

standards for business licensing, environmental compliance, waste segregation, and health and hygiene to protect student safety and welfare beyond campus grounds.





Link to Facebook Post

- **Multi-Sectoral STI Summit & Extension Convergence:** Organized by the Training and Extension Services Office (TESO) under the Office of the Vice President for Research, Innovation, and Extension (OVPRIE), the *STI Summit: Stakeholders Convergence, Program Launch, and Partnership Signing* gathered key regional entities at Teatro Ibabawnon. Participating partners included the Department of Science and Technology (DOST Region VIII), the Provincial Government of Eastern Samar, the City Government of Borongan, LGUs from San Julian and Taft, as well as local Farmers and Fisherfolk Organizations. The summit formalized collaborative extension agreements and established permanent platforms for grassroots communities and local producers to align regional priorities and steer sustainable science, technology, and innovation programs.





Link to Facebook post

- **Live Media & Public Accountability Press Conferences:** Demonstrating administrative transparency, ESSU key officials host live-broadcast mini-press conferences at Canuctan Hall. Open to media organizations, campus journalists, student leaders, and faculty, these open-floor press conferences allow stakeholders to directly question management on urgent operational decisions—such as learning setup extensions—ensuring immediate administrative accountability and public consultation.





Link to Facebook post

Through these structural representations on the Board of Regents and recurring consultative forums, ESSU reinforces an institutional environment where local stakeholders possess a meaningful, transparent voice in university decision-making.

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 16 PEACE, JUSTICE AND STRONG INSTITUTIONS

16. 2.5 University Principles on Corruption and Bribery



16 PEACE, JUSTICE AND STRONG INSTITUTIONS

In line with Sustainable Development Goal 16 (Peace, Justice, and Strong Institutions), Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) strictly enforces its formal **Anti-Bribery and Corruption Policy**—approved under **BOR Resolution No. 18, Series of 2024**—to ensure that all university operations reflect the highest standards of financial probity, integrity, and ethical public service. Grounded in the university's core values of *Excellence, Accountability, and Service*, the policy establishes an unyielding framework governing the actions of all personnel to maintain total transparency and accountability to students, parents, government partners, and external stakeholders.

1. **Scope and Ethical Governance Framework**

   The policy mandates complete coverage across all faculty, administrative staff, employees, and external stakeholders transacting with or operating on behalf of the university. It operates in conjunction with Philippine anti-graft laws—specifically Republic Act No. 3019 (*Anti-Graft and Corrupt Practices Act*) and Republic Act No. 6713 (*Code of Conduct and Ethical Standards for Public Officials and Employees*)—making corrupt practices, kickbacks, fraud, and unauthorized material interests strictly unlawful across all academic and operational divisions.

2. **Enforcement of Mandatory Accountability Measures**

   To enforce strict individual and institutional accountability, the policy governs employee conduct through explicit compliance requirements:

   - **Mandatory Financial Disclosures:** All university personnel must submit a true, detailed, and sworn **Statement of Assets, Net Worth, and Liabilities (SALN)** alongside annual conflict-of-interest disclosures to prevent financial self-interest or illicit enrichment in university transactions.
   - **Prohibition of Bribes and Unwarranted Favors:** Employees are strictly prohibited from soliciting, offering, or accepting gifts, material benefits, employment offers, or entertainment in exchange for administrative favors, contract approvals, student admissions, or license issuances.
   - **Strict Gift and Expenditure Guidelines:** Exceptions are restricted solely to unsolicited items of nominal value given as standard tokens of courtesy. All valid official expenditures, meals, and travel expenses must be recorded accurately in accordance with Commission on Audit (COA) rules.

3. **Financial Transparency and Internal Controls**

   To protect stakeholder trust and prevent misuse of public funds, the policy establishes rigorous record-keeping controls. All disbursements, procurement activities, and financial transactions involving university assets must be properly authorized, timely reported, and fully itemized in official

financial records. No university funds may be disbursed for unverified or misdescribed purposes.

4. **Protected Reporting and Institutional Oversight**

ESSU reinforces a culture of transparency by establishing a mandatory duty to report any observed or suspected violations to designated university authorities. The university guarantees strict confidentiality during investigations and enforces a **non-retaliation protection policy** to safeguard whistleblowers reporting corrupt practices in good faith. General supervision and faithful execution of the policy are maintained by the University President under the oversight of the Board of Regents, while the Public Relations and Information Management Office (PRIMO) ensures continuous public awareness and transparent access to these governance standards for all university clientele.

Policycan be accessed through this link.

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1WJYGn0fzQ8wWSfmpnVEgDgGgGHOuFE8t/view?usp=sharing

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BAGONG PILIPINAS

OFFICE OF THE BOARD OF REGENTS

EXCERPT FROM THE MINUTES OF THE 1ST SPECIAL BOARD MEETING OF THE ESSU BOARD OF REGENTS FOR C.Y. 2024 HELD ON JANUARY 31, 2024 AT HIGHER EDUCATION DEVELOPMENT CENTER (HEDC), DILIMAN, QUEZON CITY.

RESOLUTION No. 18, Series of 2024

A RESOLUTION APPROVING THE POLICIES REQUIRED FOR QS STARS APPLICATION, TO WIT:

a. Policy on Equality, Diversity and Inclusions;
b. Diversity & Inclusion: Modern Slavery;
c. Anti-Bribery and Corruption Policy;
d. Policy on Academic Freedom;
e. Sustainable Procurement Policy;
f. Sustainable Investment Policy;
g. Sustainable Funding and Donation Policy;
h. Approving the ESSU Sustainability Agenda; and
i. Student Safety Policy.

Certified Correct:

DEBBIE JOYCE R. VOLOSO, DM
Board Secretary V

The Eastern Samar State University Anti-Bribery and Corruption Policy

Policy Statement:

The Eastern Samar State University (the University) is committed to conducting its academic, administrative, and business activities with the highest standards consistent with its Vision, Mission, Goals and Objectives and guided by the University Core Values of Excellence, Accountability and Service.

The University hereby adopts this Anti-Bribery and Corruption Policy (the Policy) which shall be read in conjunction with other University Governance policies, Republic Act No. 3019 or the Anti-Graft and Corrupt Practices Act as amended , Republic Act No. 6713 or the Code of Conduct and Ethical Standards for Public Officials and Employees" and Jurisprudence relating thereto, and other applicable Laws and Issuances of the Republic of the Philippines (the Republic).

Purpose: The purpose of this Policy is to provide guidelines to ALL University faculty, staff/personnel/employees and stakeholders in the adoption of and commitment to support this Anti-Bribery and Corruption Policy as part of the University's continuous improvement in its governance.

Scope: ALL University faculty, staff/personnel/employees and stakeholders who works/operates/transacts/associates or in any manner, directly or indirectly deals in/with/for the University.

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SDG 16 PEACE, JUSTICE AND STRONG INSTITUTIONS

16.2.6 Academic Freedom Policy



16 PEACE, JUSTICE AND STRONG INSTITUTIONS

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) upholds an active, university-wide Academic Freedom Policy codified within Section 8.0 (*Design and Implementation of the Research Program*) of the **Academic Affairs Office Operations Manual (Version 3)**. In accordance with the 1987 Philippine Constitution, institutional governance standards, and the original charter of the university enacted as RA No 9312, ESSU guarantees the fundamental right of academic freedom to all members of its teaching force, safeguarding their autonomy to select research areas, disseminate findings, and exercise pedagogical freedom without administrative or external interference.

The policy explicitly structures and protects academic freedom across all academic ranks:

- **Research Freedom for Senior Academics:** Senior academics—holding *plantilla* positions of **Associate Professor** and **Full Professor**—are guaranteed absolute freedom to select their research topics based on their academic interest, specialization, and training (Provision 8.0.1). Under university guidelines, senior faculty are mandated to complete and present at least two research outputs every three years, supported by workload reduction incentives or honoraria.

- **Research Freedom for Junior Academics:** Junior academics—comprising faculty with *plantilla* positions of **Instructor** and **Assistant Professor**—are explicitly protected under the policy. Section 8.0 clarifies that faculty holding lower academic ranks are not barred from engaging in research independently or in partnership with senior scholars, ensuring junior faculty enjoy equal autonomy in selecting research subjects aligning with their discipline and professional training (Provision 8.0.1).

- **Teaching Freedom for Senior Academics:** Senior faculty members (Associate and Full Professors) possess pedagogical autonomy to discuss, evaluate, and integrate their research findings and ethical inquiry into classroom instruction, in-house reviews, and public symposia without fear of administrative reprisal or censorship.

- **Teaching Freedom for Junior Academics:** Instructors and Assistant Professors are granted equal instructional freedom, allowing junior scholars to teach, publicly present research outputs, and engage in inter-college or external multi-sectoral research collaborations to enrich their instructional delivery.

ESSU-OOM-ACAD/ Version 3

OPERATIONS MANUAL

ACADEMIC AFFAIRS

8.0 Design and Implementation of the Research Program

Research is one of the mandated functions of faculty members in a state university. Even if NBC 461 requires only the full professors to perform research and extension or production functions, the other faculty members holding lower academic ranks are not barred from engaging in research individually or in partnership with senior faculty. In this regard, within a period of two years, Assistant Professors are expected to complete and present at least one research output while Associate Professors and Full Professors are required to complete and present two outputs within a three-year period either in agency in-house reviews or invitational research forum/symposium.

The conduct of research in the Eastern Samar State University is guided by the following principles:

1. Researchers are free to choose the subject of their research according to their interest, discipline and training.
2. Research methods and results should be open to scrutiny.
3. University researches shall be conducted responsibly and ethically. Researches should, in all aspects demonstrate integrity and professionalism, observe fairness and equity, avoid conflict of interest, ensure the safety of those involved in the research and uphold the rights and dignity of the subjects involved in the research.
4. Research should be conducted within the legislative framework applicable to it.
5. A research may be conducted individually or in collaboration with researchers within and across colleges or campuses of the University, with other government organizations, non-government organizations, people's organizations, industry or private individuals.
6. A faculty shall not conduct or be part of more than two (2) research projects within a year in order not to jeopardize his instruction and other functions.

Research Work Equivalency

UNIVERSITY
CONTROLLED

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Reduced workload incentive of 3 units shall be given to a faculty who is a study leader, a project leader, or a program leader of a research project. However, a faculty cannot have more than two researches in a particular calendar year. Moreover, a faculty may decide whether to avail of reduced workload incentive or honorarium. He/she can only avail of the latter if he/she has an academic workload not lower than 21 units per semester or should have a teaching assignment of 21 hours per week.

8.0.1 Guidelines for Conduct of Faculty Researches

The guidelines for the conduct of faculty research starting from proposal development and initial review; processing of full blown research proposals; research funding policy and preparation of the research budget; implementation of approved proposals; monitoring and evaluation procedures; and documentation, reporting, presentation and publication of completed researches are thoroughly discussed in the Operations Manual of the Research and Development Services unit.

Republic of the Philippines
EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY
Borongan City, Eastern Samar

THE REVISED CODE
OF
EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY

GENERAL PROVISIONS

SECTION 1: This code shall be known as "Revised CODE of EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY."

SECTION 2: ***The ESSU***

The Eastern Samar State University, or ESSU, is a public non-sectarian, non-profit institution of higher learning. The University shall primarily provide advanced education, higher technological, professional instruction and training in the fields of industry, computer and information technology, forestry and environmental sciences, agriculture and veterinary medicine, fishery, medicine and related sciences, engineering, education, law, arts and sciences, and other related sciences, engineering, education, law, arts, and sciences, and other related fields of study. It shall also promote research, extension and production services, and provide progressive leadership in its areas of specialization.

SECTION 3. *Academic Principles in the Conduct and*

Management of Research

a. **Academic Responsibility.** All academic staff shall be involved in research in order to advance the frontier of knowledge particularly in their area of expertise.

b. **Academic Freedom.** Research are free to choose the subject of research according to their interest, discipline and training provided these are within the research priority of the University.

c. **Excellence.** The pursuit of excellence in research is central to the development, support and assessment of all research activities. Excellence in research could be demonstrated by the knowledge contributed by the research output in terms of developed methods or techniques, and the solution of practical, technological, social and economic problems.

d. **Peer Review.** Judgments about research excellence must be made by those best able to assess the quality of research output. Equity and Equality. The University shall commit to the fundamental right of tis entire staff to have the opportunity to undertake research, and to the

appointment of all research–related positions with its general policies.

e. **Research Ethics.** The University shall maintain strict control over all research activities involving human, animal and other organism, and work in which issues of biosafety are involved.

f. **Health and Safety.** The University accepts the general obligation, encompassing research responsibility for providing a healthy and safe workplace for its staff, students and guests.

g. **Intellectual Property Rights.** The University retains certain rights of intellectual property ownership with respect to patents resulting from both University supported and sponsored or commissioned researches.

h. **Research Budgets and Costing.** The University is committed to the general principle of full cost recovery for externally funded researches as part of its responsible management of public resources.

i. **Research Training and Higher Degrees** The University shall provide support for research staff to pursue advanced graduate and postgraduate studies in their field of specialization consistent with the needs and policies of the University. Research groups and individual staff

been complied with; and provided finally, that in exceptional and meritorious cases, the President of the University may grant exceptions to the foregoing rules.

f. Faculty members may be designated to assume managerial or supervisory functions on top of their teaching assignments. Such designations shall carry the necessary benefits and privileges attached to the position, subject to existing rules and laws. Designation of faculty members and other officials shall not, however, be compulsory unless exigency of service requires.

g. Faculty members duly assigned adviser of student's thesis/dissertation shall be entitled to honoraria in accordance with university rules and regulations or as determined by the Board of Regents.

h. Deans or equivalent heads of units shall submit to the President of the University for approval the names of faculty members entitled to receive honoraria for services beyond the normal load requirements.

SECTION 6. *Academic Freedom of Teachers.*

a. Members of the teaching staff shall enjoy academic freedom.

b. Academic freedom is the right of the faculty to teach the subject, according to his/her best judgment, to uphold in other subjects such ideas as the teacher believes sincerely to be right, and to express opinion on public questions in a manner that shall not interfere with his/her duties as a member of the faculty or jeopardize his/her loyalty to the university.

c. No faculty in the University shall inculcate sectarian tenets in any of his/her teachings, nor use his/her position, directly or indirectly, to influence students for or against any particular church or religious sect, ideology, or political party.

d. If the conduct of a faculty member or teacher in the classroom or elsewhere gives rise to doubts concerning fitness for his/her position, the question in such cases shall be submitted to the office of his/her immediate superior. In no case shall any member of the teaching staff be dismissed before the normal termination of the period of appointment as faculty member without due process of law.

e. The University shall assume no responsibility for personal views expressed by faculty members or its staff. The faculty members themselves shall

make clear that what they are expressing are their personal opinions or views.

SECTION 7. *Other Activities.*

a. Other allowable activities of university personnel includes limited practice of profession, outside consultancy, special detail to government and other agencies, and other activities or projects which are not considered integral functions of the University.

b. Prior authorization to engage in such activities shall be secured from the President of the University upon endorsement by the head of the unit concerned.

c. Permission to engage in outside activities shall be for a period not exceeding one year, subject to renewal at the discretion of the President upon recommendation of the head of the unit or office concerned.

d. Outside activities that are beyond the regular workload in the University shall not exceed six (6) hours a week.

SECTION 8. *Service Report.*

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16.2.7 Publish Financial Data



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Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) demonstrates a resolute commitment to public governance, financial probity, and institutional viability. To uphold fiscal integrity and ensure robust public scrutiny, ESSU maintains an open-access repository of comprehensive financial disclosures directly accessible on its official website (essu.edu.ph).

ESSU's publicly disclosed financial portfolio provides rigorous, multi-dimensional evidence of the university's solvency, fiscal discipline, and adherence to standard government accounting rules (Generally Accepted Accounting Principles / GAM standards):

- Financial Viability and Operational Performance: Through the public publication of consolidated financial disclosures—including the Financial Report of Operations, Income, and Disbursements—ESSU enables stakeholders and independent evaluators to assess the university's fiscal stability, operational efficiency, and overall revenue-to-expenditure health.

- Budgetary Integrity and Oversight: Detailed accountability mechanisms, such as the Statement of Allotment, Obligation, and Balances, DBM Approved Budget and Targets, and Financial Accountability Reports (FARs), offer complete visibility into how public funds are allocated, managed, and executed across all academic and administrative divisions.

- Project Delivery and Procurement Compliance: The open publication of the Annual Procurement Plan (APP), Contracts Awarded and the Name of Contractors/Suppliers/Consultants, alongside comprehensive reports on Projects, Programs and Activities, Beneficiaries, and Status of Implementation, guarantees full transparency in supply chain processes, infrastructure development, and resource deployment.

- Equitable Stewardship and Physical Verification: ESSU integrates operational metrics with fiscal accountability by publishing the annual Physical Report of assets alongside targeted disclosures on institutional equity, such as the Gender Pay Gap report, underscoring a commitment to ethical governance, social equity, and responsible resource stewardship.

By ensuring that all primary financial records, procurement trails, and budget executions are openly downloadable and accessible for public audit, ESSU fulfills THE Sustainability Impact methodology requirements for financial probity—proving that its growth and academic missions are anchored in institutional integrity, fiscal responsibility, and transparent public governance.



Screen capture taken from the ESSU website detailing all of the publicly available finance-related reports of the University for various years.

Annual Financial Reports

- Physical Report
- Financial Report of Operations
- Income
- Statement of Allotment, Obligation, and Balances
- Disbursements
- Financial Accountability Reports
- DBM Approved Budget and Targets
- Projects, Programs and Activities, Beneficiaries, and Status of Implementation
- Annual Procurement Plan
- Contracts Awarded and the Name of Contractors/Suppliers/Consultants
- Gender Pay Gap

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16.3.1 Working with National Government



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Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) systematically provides specialized academic expertise, empirical evidence, and policy guidance to local, regional, and national government bodies. Through active participation in government committees, technical working groups, and collaborative policy forums, ESSU faculty and research specialists directly inform public administration and sustainable development strategies.

1. **Expert Advice to Local Government Units (LGUs)**

   A. Academic Consultation on Education Policy & Capacity Building (DepEd Eastern Samar Division)



Provision of Advice & Expert Guidance:

Through *Project TUL-ID* (Technical Upskilling via Ladderized, Intensive, and Multi-tiered Dynamic Approach to Research Capacity Building), ESSU Graduate School faculty experts provided technical policy guidance and capacity-building expertise to school research coordinators, master teachers, and basic education educators across the southern school districts of Eastern Samar. Building on evidence from the Eastern Samar Basic Education Research Forum (ESBERF), ESSU experts delivered technical mentorship in research design, data analytics, and proposal development to directly assist local educators in translating classroom data into actionable, evidence-based local school policies and educational interventions. Link to Facebook post.

B. "SMART WASTE SOLUTION" training extension initiative



Provision of Advice & Expert Guidance:

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) Can-avid Campus, through its College of Computer Studies (CCS), provided specialized technical expertise, data systems guidance, and policy support to the Municipal Government of Can-avid, Eastern Samar, through the "SMART WASTE SOLUTION" training extension initiative (Information System and Waste Volume Characterization).

Led by CCS Dean Prof. Mylene B. Ragobrio, ICTC Director Shoven Afable, CCS core faculty, and BSIT alumni, university experts convened key local governance stakeholders—including the Municipal Environment and Natural Resources Office (MENRO) headed by Gerry Amoyan, local government unit (LGU) officials led by Municipal Mayor Hon. Alicia Leguin Teves, and local Barangay Captains.

Through this collaborative extension project, ESSU provided direct technical guidance on developing digital information systems and waste volume characterization frameworks. By equipping municipal officials and barangay leaders with technology-driven data tools and sustainable waste management strategies, ESSU directly advised local government decision-makers on embedding innovation into municipal environmental policies, optimizing local waste collection systems, and building climate-resilient, sustainable communities across the municipality. Link to Facebook post.

C. Ka Enbaysay Faculty Lead Borongan's Bamboo Industry Planning



Provision of Specific Expert Advice:

Faculty members from Eastern Samar State University's (ESSU) Environmental Science Department (ESD) provided technical policy guidance, scientific evidence, and facilitation expertise to the Borongan City Local Government Unit (LGU) during the Borongan City Bamboo Industry Development Council (BC-BIDC) Meeting and the three-day Bamboo Industry Development Planning Workshop. Serving as technical design leads, resource speakers, and facilitators, the ESSU team—comprising Marciano B. Cadalin, Edgar I. Peque, Rebecca A. Corre, Lylah Daisy A. Acorin, and College R&D Coordinator Rey Niel C. Salac—delivered expert policy advice grounded in environmental analysis, participatory planning, and scientific field data. The team presented empirical findings from its initial bamboo resource mapping across Borongan's barangays, providing the essential baseline data needed for city officials, the Department of Trade and Industry (DTI), and the Department of Environment and Natural Resources (DENR) to review City Ordinance No. 242, s. 2022.

Collaborating with the Borongan City Environment and Natural Resources Office (BCENRO) and DTI Eastern Samar, ESSU guided city decision-makers through situational analyses, SWOT evaluations, vision setting, and action planning. These collaborative sessions culminated in the formulation of draft sectoral action plans for bamboo propagation, processing, marketing, and support services. Designed for formal submission and adoption by the Sangguniang Panlungsod (City Council) as Borongan City's official Local Bamboo Industry Development Plan (LBIDP), this initiative—anchored on ESD's Socioecological-based Actions for Vital Ecosystems (SAVEs) program—underscores ESSU's role as a trusted academic advisor driving evidence-informed local government policy, climate resilience, and sustainable community enterprises. Link to Facebook post.

D. Institutional Governance Policy & Capacity Building (DILG Region VIII / Local Government Academy)



Provision of Advice:

ESSU senior executive leadership met with officials from the Department of the Interior and Local Government (DILG) Eastern Samar Cluster and the Local Government Academy (LGA) to establish a dedicated *Center for Governance*. Serving as an official Learning Resource Institution (LRI) partner, ESSU leverages its Political Science and extension capabilities to provide continuous technical instruction, policy review, and administrative capacity building for elected and appointed local officials from the barangay to the provincial level. Link to Facebook post.

E. Disaster-Resilient Communication Infrastructure (ESPSTIC & DRR Committee)



Provision of Advice:

Sitting as a key academic member of the Eastern Samar Provincial Science, Technology, and Innovation Council (ESPSTIC) Disaster Risk Reduction Committee, ESSU provided expert technical evaluation for *Project ARMOR* (*Advanced Redundant Messaging for Operational Response*). ESSU specialists advised provincial government bodies, the Provincial Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Office (PDRRMO), and regional military/civil defense units on integrating redundant messaging systems to optimize real-time emergency communications and regional disaster response capabilities. Link to Facebook post.

2. Expert Advice to Regional Government Agencies

A. Child-Sensitive Climate Risk & Local Development Guidance (LGUs of Leyte and Eastern Samar)



Provision of Advice:

ESSU's Environmental Science Department provided scientific expertise during the multi-stakeholder kick-off of the *Child-Sensitive Climate Risk and Vulnerability Assessment (CRVA)* project in partnership with EVSU and local municipal governments across Leyte and Eastern Samar. ESSU academic specialists provided technical guidance on deploying scientific assessment tools that evaluate extreme weather and climate vulnerabilities affecting children, directly advising municipal planners on how to embed child-focused vulnerability data into local development plans and LGU climate adaptation policies. Link to Facebook post.

B. SMART Disaster Risk Reduction & Technology Innovation (DOST-PSTO Region VIII)



Provision of Advice:

ESSU's Research, Development, and Extension (RDE) unit and the Smart Technologies Research, Development and Innovation Center (STRDIC) provided technical expertise to the Department of Science and Technology - Provincial Science and Technology Office (DOST-PSTO) during strategic consultations on *SMART DRR Innovations*. ESSU researchers provided policy and technological guidance on leveraging university-generated research to build science-based early warning systems and sustainable risk reduction frameworks across the province. Link to Facebook post.

3. Expert Advice to National Government Bodies

A. DSWD Renews Partnership with ESSU on 4Ps Implementation



Provision of Specific Expert Advice:

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU)—led by University President Dr. Andres C. Pagatpatan, Jr., the Training and Extension Services Office (TESO) under Dr. Maria Natalia Ciasico, and faculty experts from the College of Technology (COT) and the College of Arts and Social Sciences (CASS)—provided technical expertise, policy evaluation, and strategic advisory to the Department of Social Work and Development (DSWD) Field Office VIII during a high-level consultative meeting. Meeting with Mr. Reden M. Sabela, Institutional Partnership and Development Officer of the 4Ps Management Division, ESSU presented empirical status reports and outcome assessments based on its previous lead implementation of the Pantawid Pamilyang Pilipino Program (4Ps).

Drawing from academic research and field implementation data, ESSU experts advised DSWD FO VIII on optimizing the regional execution of the 4Ps framework through a reenergized, holistic strategy that prioritizes values formation prior to skills development to maximize long-term socio-economic impact. Furthermore, ESSU provided policy guidance on scaling the initiative into a unified, system-wide institutional model engaging all ESSU colleges and campuses across the province. Through this technical collaboration, ESSU directly shapes regional social protection policies, advising government social welfare agencies on implementing inclusive, values-driven, and results-oriented community interventions. Link to Facebook post.

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16.3.2 Policy and Lawmakers Outreach



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Demonstrating its institutional commitment to providing structured outreach, capacity-building, and education to policy- and lawmakers, Eastern Samar State University (ESSU)—led by University President Dr. Andres C. Pagatpatan, Jr. and Vice President for Academic Affairs Dr. Vicente A. Agda, Jr.—convened a strategic Partnership and Consultative Meeting with key representatives from the Department of the Interior and Local Government (DILG) Eastern Samar Cluster, led by Cluster Head Jerry A. Enrique (LGOO VI).

The partnership establishes a concrete framework for launching a dedicated **Center for Governance**, an institutionalized, instruction-based extension program managed by ESSU's Training & Extension Services Office (TESO) in collaboration with the Political Science Department. Serving as an official **Learning Resource Institution (LRI)** partner of the DILG and the Local Government Academy (LGA), ESSU delivers specialized educational curricula, practical upskilling, and policy training tailored for elected and appointed local lawmakers and public officials—ranging from barangay captains and municipal councilors to provincial policy-makers.

Through this collaborative LRI model, ESSU leverages its academic research strengths and instructional capabilities to train newly elected officials and advance the operational competencies of incumbent lawmakers in critical areas of public administration, local legislation, environmental governance, and community development. By merging DILG's policy authority with university-led outreach and education, ESSU directly capacity-builds local policy-makers to enhance public sector efficiency, foster inclusive governance, and drive evidence-informed, sustainable policy-making across Eastern Samar. Link to Facebook post.



In line with its institutional commitment to providing outreach, general education, upskilling, and capacity-building to policy- and lawmakers on environmental governance and climate resilience, Eastern Samar State University (ESSU)—represented by its environmental science professors and academic experts—participated in and provided technical guidance during a Consultative Meeting called by the Committee on Environment and Climate Change of the Sangguniang Panlungsod (City Council) of Borongan City.

The consultative session, presided over by SPM Rozene D. Daza (Committee Chairperson), focused on reviewing a proposed legislative measure: *"An Ordinance Declaring Certain Areas in Borongan City as Forest Reserves as Identified in the Approved Forest Land Use Plan (FLUP) Providing Regulations and Imposing Penalties for Violations Thereof"*. This urgent legislative action responded to a formal communication from the Liga ng mga Barangay (LnB) Borongan City Chapter opposing destructive mining operations—specifically open-pit mining—to safeguard the city's watersheds, agricultural lands, coastal ecosystems, water supply, and food security from environmental degradation and flood risks.

By engaging directly with city lawmakers, alongside key municipal department heads (City ENRO, City Agriculture Office, CPDO) and DENR officials (PENRO Eastern Samar and CENRO Borongan), ESSU academic experts provided essential scientific analysis, policy orientation, and capacity-building to local legislators. Through this partnership, ESSU actively educates and equips local policy-makers with the scientific foundation needed to formulate robust, evidence-informed environmental legislation, protect critical watersheds, and enhance regional climate disaster preparedness. Link to Facebook post.

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16.3.3 Participation in Government Research



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April 1–2, 2025 — Demonstrating its commitment to inter-agency academic research, public policy formulation, and climate resilience, Eastern Samar State University (ESSU)—through its Environmental Science Department (ESD)—partnered with Eastern Visayas State University (EVSU), Save the Children Philippines, and four local government units (LGUs) across Leyte and Eastern Samar to launch the Child-Sensitive Climate Risk and Vulnerability Assessment (CRVA) project. Represented by Professor Edgar I. Peque and Mr. Marciano B. Cadalin during the Project Kick-off and Stakeholders Consultation in Tacloban City, ESSU joined representatives from civil society, the private sector, and regional government agencies to establish research-driven climate adaptation strategies.

The CRVA project is an inter-institutional research initiative designed to deploy a scientific assessment tool that systematically evaluates climate-related risks—such as extreme weather, food insecurity, and health threats—impacting vulnerable child populations. By serving as an academic research partner, ESSU bridges scientific inquiry and grassroots policy formulation, providing technical guidance to help LGUs embed child-centered vulnerability data directly into local development plans, disaster risk frameworks, and regional governance policies. Through this multi-sectoral collaboration, ESSU reinforces its role as a key state university driving participatory government research, evidence-based policymaking, and sustainable community resilience. Link to Facebook post.



May 21, 2025 — Demonstrating its commitment to government-partnered research, public safety, and evidence-based disaster resilience, Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) actively engaged as an academic research and technical collaborator in the initiation of **Project ARMOR** (*Advanced Redundant Messaging for Operational Response*). Convened by the Eastern Samar Provincial Science, Technology, and Innovation Council (ESPSTIC) at the Provincial Disaster Risk Reduction and Management (PDRRM) Office, the collaborative session brought together ESSU, the Department of Science and Technology - Provincial Science and Technology Office (DOST-PSTO), the Provincial Government of Eastern Samar, DICT, DTI, PPDO, and the Philippine Army.

Project ARMOR is a needs-based, technology-integrated research initiative designed to establish a disaster-resilient emergency communication network across Eastern Samar. By contributing academic expertise, research capability, and technical guidance, ESSU supports the government's mission to deploy redundant messaging facilities at strategic locations—ensuring real-time information exchange, accelerating emergency response coordination, and mitigating disaster risks for vulnerable local communities. Through this inter-agency partnership, ESSU reinforces its role as a key state university driving sustainable development and participatory government research. Link to Facebook post.



May 27, 2025 — Demonstrating its ongoing commitment to participatory government research, science-based policymaking, and regional disaster resilience, Eastern Samar State University (ESSU)—through its Research, Development, and Extension (RDE) unit and the Smart Technologies Research, Development and Innovation Center (STRDIC)—partnered with the Department of Science and Technology - Eastern Samar Provincial Science and Technology Office (DOST-PSTO) for a strategic consultative meeting on SMART Disaster Risk Reduction (DRR) Innovations in Borongan City.

The collaborative initiative focuses on co-developing and deploying modern, technology-driven research solutions to build climate-resilient and disaster-ready communities across Eastern Samar. By leveraging university research outputs and integrating academic expertise with DOST's provincial science ecosystem, ESSU actively contributes to designing science-based early warning systems, emergency response frameworks, and sustainable risk-reduction strategies. Through this inter-institutional research partnership, ESSU reinforces its role as a key state university driving technological innovation, evidence-based public safety planning, and collaborative governance research. Link to Facebook post.





November 11–13, 2025 — Demonstrating its commitment to institutional collaboration, capacity building, and evidence-based educational research, Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) Main Campus' Graduate School, in partnership with the Department of Education (DepEd) Eastern Samar Division, launched the maiden edition of **Project TUL-ID** (*Technical Upskilling via Ladderized, Intensive, and Multi-tiered Dynamic Approach to Research Capacity Building*). Conceived by core faculty member Dr. Riomar G. Obliopas, the three-day intensive seminar-workshop brought together school research coordinators, district research coordinators, master teachers, and basic education educators from across the province's southern school districts.

Project TUL-ID is a needs-based, multi-tiered research capacity-building program designed in direct response to findings from the Eastern Samar Basic Education Research Forum (ESBERF). Recognizing the imperative to enhance basic education research productivity and rigor, ESSU faculty experts—in collaboration with DepEd research leaders—provided comprehensive, hands-on training on research methodologies, theoretical frameworks, data analysis, fundable proposal packaging, and publishable report writing. By guiding local public school teachers through the complete research lifecycle, ESSU actively supports the government's drive to translate scholarly findings into impactful, classroom-level policies and evidence-based educational reforms across Eastern Samar. Link to Facebook post.

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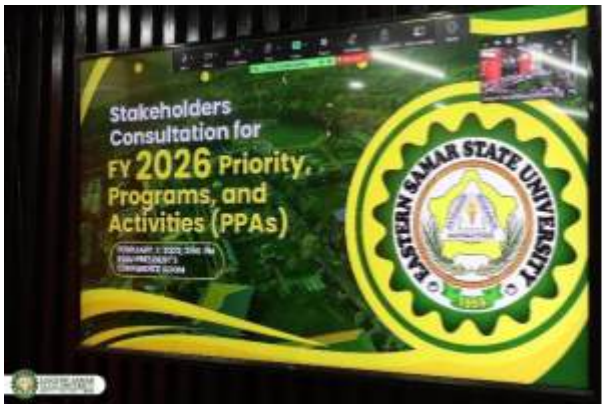
16.3.4 Neutral Platforms to Discuss Issues



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Institutional Commitment: Providing a Neutral Platform for Frank Dialogue

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) actively functions to provide a neutral platform and 'safe' space for different political stakeholders to come together to frankly discuss challenges. Grounded in institutional commitment to open academic discourse, ESSU ensures that people and organizations with widely different views can debate and discuss important issues without restriction from the university (within an appropriate legal framework). Through this institutional safe space, the university consistently brings its academic expertise to bear to the benefit of political decision making, civic consensus, and regional resilience. The administration cultivates an institutional culture that is always open for dialogues regarding issues and challenges faced by the university and its clients, regularly convening students, parents, faculty, non-academic personnel, transport federations, civil society organizations, local chief executives, and national government authorities. To satisfy THE evidence validation criteria requiring direct, self-contained documentation, the chronological record of multi-stakeholder consultations conducted by ESSU during 2025 is detailed below.





On February 7, 2025, the university convened a consultation to deliberate on the proposed Priority Programs and Activities (PPAs) for Financial Year 2026 to ensure institutional plans align with community needs, university strategic thrusts, and regional and national development agendas. Organized by the Institutional Planning and Development Office (IPDO) at the President's Conference Room of the ESSU Main Campus, the hybrid dialogue gathered university planning officers, budget officers, campus representatives across all ESSU branches via Zoom, partner groups, and community beneficiaries of various university extension programs. Through this participatory review, the university resolved to integrate the critical feedback, evaluations, and programmatic recommendations directly into the finalized 2026 Priority Programs and Activities blueprint. See Link to Facebook post.





On February 19, 2025, a multi-issue stakeholders' consultation was held at Canuctan Hall on the ESSU Main Campus to resolve several pressing administrative matters, namely the cultural transition to the "Sal-ong" graduation regalia under Board of Regents Resolution No. 66, Series of 2024, a proposed tuition fee adjustment from Php 100 to Php 300 per unit under the state-subsidized Universal Access to Quality Tertiary Education framework, the implementation of a Mandatory Sticker Gate Pass policy costing Php 170 per year for campus safety, and the introduction of a new prescribed student uniform. Organized by the Office of the Vice President for Academic Affairs (OVPAA), the assembly was attended by University President Dr. Andres C. Pagatpatan, Jr., Vice President for Administration Dr. Rhodora C. Mendoza, Vice President for External Affairs and Quality Assurance Dr. Jocelyn S. Castro, Public Relations and Information Management Office (PRIMO) Director Ms. Maria Ayreen B. Elpedes, Student Services and Alumni Affairs (SSAA) Dean Dr. Aris A. Lapada, Auxiliary Services/IGP Director Mr. Nelson Torillo, College of Nursing and Allied Sciences representative Mr. Deo Nicart, student leaders from across all ESSU campus student councils, the Federated Supreme Student Council, Federated Class Organization officers, alumni, parents, and members of the ESSU Tricycle Operators & Drivers Association (ESSU-TODA). The assembly resolved to adopt the Sal-ong as the official cultural regalia, reached an overwhelming majority vote among parents and students supporting the 200% tuition fee adjustment to secure expanded government remittances for academic facility modernization,

established balanced gate pass operational guidelines that grant employees one free pass while requiring driver registration to safeguard livelihoods alongside campus safety, and confirmed that the uniform mandate will apply exclusively to incoming freshmen while exempting the College of Nursing. See link to Facebook post.




March 14, 2025 at ESSU Can-Avid - Upholding principles of transparent governance, participatory dialogue, and institutional accountability, the College of Agriculture at Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) convened a General Assembly and Parents' Consultation for Bachelor of Science in Agriculture stakeholders. Led by College Dean For. Cristita O. Subere, Program Head Mrs. Rhodora G. Pomasin, and OJT Coordinator Sir Darwin H. Calvo, university officials delivered comprehensive briefings on academic standings, curriculum completion, institutional clearance processes, financial fees, and host training establishment placements.

Crucially, the assembly featured an open consultative forum operating as a safe, neutral space where parents, guardians, and students were given absolute freedom to raise concerns, critique institutional policies, and bring operational challenges to light. By guaranteeing a transparent platform free from fear of reprisal, discrimination, or institutional sanction from ESSU, the university reinforced collaborative problem-solving, stakeholder empowerment, and trust-building within the academic community. See link to Facebook post.





On April 1–2, 2025, a regional consultative dialogue and project kick-off in Tacloban City addressed the mainstreaming of child-sensitive climate resilience and vulnerability assessments into public governance. Led by Save the Children Philippines under Environment and Climate Change Advisor Rexel Abrigo, the forum was represented by ESSU Environmental Science Department faculty Professor Edgar I. Peque and Mr. Marciano B. Cadalin, who engaged alongside delegates from Eastern Visayas State University (EVSU), regional government departments, private sector stakeholders, civil society organizations, and officials from four Local Government Units (LGUs) across Leyte and Eastern Samar. The consultation culminated in a formal inter-agency commitment from participating LGUs and academic institutions to integrate the Child-Sensitive Climate Risk and Vulnerability Assessment (CRVA) tool into local development policies and comprehensive land use frameworks, backed by collaborative resource-sharing arrangements. See link to Facebook post.





On April 24, 2025, an institutional dialogue at the Students' Pavilion of the Main Campus tackled procedural guidelines, student welfare measures, and host-country safety protocols concerning the Student Internship Abroad Program (SIAP). Organized by the Office of the Student Internship Program (OSIP) head Dr. Lucila C. Habac alongside Vice President for External Affairs and Quality Assurance Dr. Jocelyn R. Castro and College of Hospitality Management (CHM) Internship Coordinator Ms. Evarose Q. Tabunda, the session engaged third-year students, their parents, and Outbound Education and Internship (OBEI) Executive Director for Eastern Visayas Operations Mr. John Jerick F. Postreros. The consultation resolved parent and learner concerns regarding international arrangements, confirming placements and international deployment pathways for student cohorts to partner institutions in Thailand, France, and the United States. See link to Facebook post.



On July 18, 2025, a consultative assembly was convened at the Old Social Hall of ESSU Maydolong Campus to discuss co-curricular plans, programmatic directions, and community engagement initiatives for the Bachelor of Physical Education (BPED) curriculum. Facilitated by the BPED-ABTIK student organization, participants included BPED undergraduate students, academic department faculty, parents, and local industry partners. The session concluded with the ratification of the annual co-curricular calendar and the alignment of experiential training plans with industry expectations and stakeholder feedback. See link to Facebook post.





On July 22, 2025, a high-level consultation at the Faculty Lounge of the ESSU Main Campus addressed the operationalization of a multi-sectoral Center for

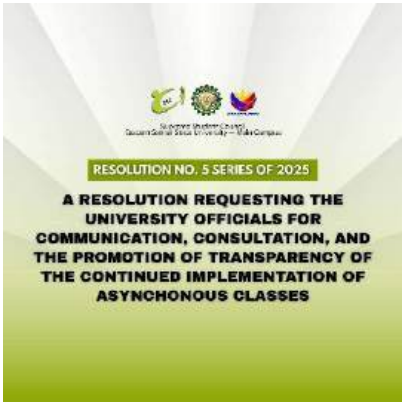
Governance dedicated to training elected and appointed local officials from the barangay to provincial levels. The meeting brought together University President Dr. Andres C. Pagatpatan, Jr. and Vice President for Academic Affairs Dr. Vicente A. Agda, Jr. alongside Department of the Interior and Local Government (DILG) Eastern Samar Cluster Head Mr. Jerry A. Enrique (LGOO VI), Ms. Dionesa Marie Apura (LGOO III), Mr. Jewel Costuna (LGOO II), and representatives from the ESSU Training & Extension Services Office (TESO) and the Political Science Department. The consultation finalized an operational roadmap designating ESSU as an official Learning Resource Institution (LRI) partner for the DILG, combining state administrative authority with university instruction and research expertise to foster transparent public administration. See link to Facebook post.

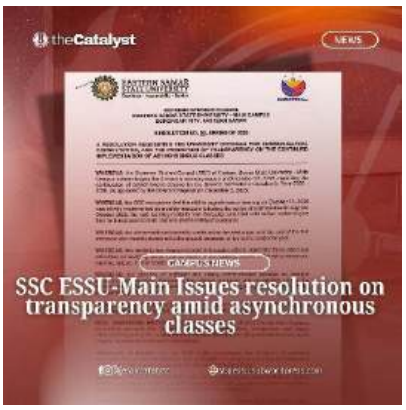




On July 28, 2025, a technical and operational consultation session took place at the Faculty Lounge to identify infrastructure bottlenecks, digital workflows, and automation priorities for the institutional Information Systems Strategic Plan (ISSP). Led by Vice President for Academic Affairs Dr. Vicente A. Agda, Jr., Smart Technologies Research Development and Innovation Center (STRDIC) Director Engr. Elizabeth Z. Calvo, and ICTC Director Mr. Alfredo Cebricus, the meeting engaged IT specialists from the College of Computer Studies (CCS) across campuses as well as administrative end-users representing the Human Resource Management Office, Research, Innovation and Extension Office, Knowledge

Management Office, and PRIMO. The session successfully resolved cross-departmental requirements to draft the centralized ISSP architectural plan, establishing an institutional digital roadmap for employee management, intellectual property tracking, and research oversight. See link to Facebook post.





During October 2025, the university addressed campus safety concerns and student requests for institutional transparency following seismic shocks, as formally petitioned under Supreme Student Council (SSC) Resolution No. 05, Series of 2025. Consultations involved SSC Main Campus student leaders, university administrators, the Special Committee and Task Force on Structural Analysis, the Student Regent, and the Board of Regents (BOR) chaired by CHED Commissioner Dr. Desiderio R. Apag III. In direct response, the administration enacted an immediate transition to asynchronous instruction to safeguard learners, while the Board passed Resolution No. 237 allocating Php 5,259,840.00 from the Internally Generated Fund for professional structural assessments of affected facilities, and Resolution No. 254 allocating Php 13,729,123.74 for structural repairs and the construction of three temporary classroom facilities. Full transparency was upheld by granting the SSC official copies of all recovery resolutions for public student dissemination, while depositing complete physical copies at the Office of Student Affairs (OSA) for open community review. See link to Facebook post





December 26, 2025 — In commitment to open dialogue, Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) convened a mini-press conference at the Canuctan Hall of the Main Campus to address community concerns regarding its academic operations. Broadcasted live on the university's official Facebook page along with several local news outlets, the forum brought together student leaders, faculty members, campus journalists, and local media representatives to directly engage key university officials following public discussions on the extension of asynchronous learning for the second semester of Academic Year 2025–2026.

Designed as an uninhibited space for constructive dialogue, the press conference granted attending stakeholders full freedom to raise critical questions, air grievances, and challenge administrative decisions without fear of reprisal or institutional sanction from ESSU. By upholding non-retaliation, academic freedom, and administrative accountability, the university demonstrated its commitment to maintaining safe spaces for open inquiry and collaborative problem-solving across all its campuses. See link to Facebook post.